

Will Baker 2026
Design Portfolio

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Portfolio

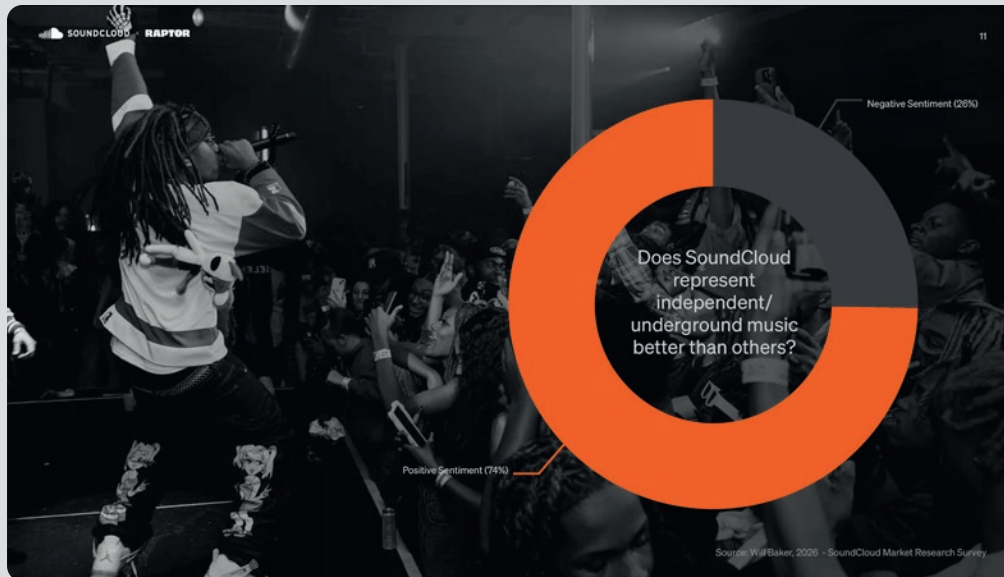
SoundCloud Pulse

SoundCloud Pulse was developed as part of the 2026 Raptor Academy Program. We were asked to select a global brand that we believed could engage with Gen Z audiences more effectively, and develop a campaign proposal that shows how they could do that in a way that's relevant, credible and culturally connected.

I chose SoundCloud, as despite being a culture powerhouse, they suffer from nearly zero brand visibility. While Gen Z deeply aligns with SoundCloud's core values of community and artist support, data shows that most still default to competing streaming services.

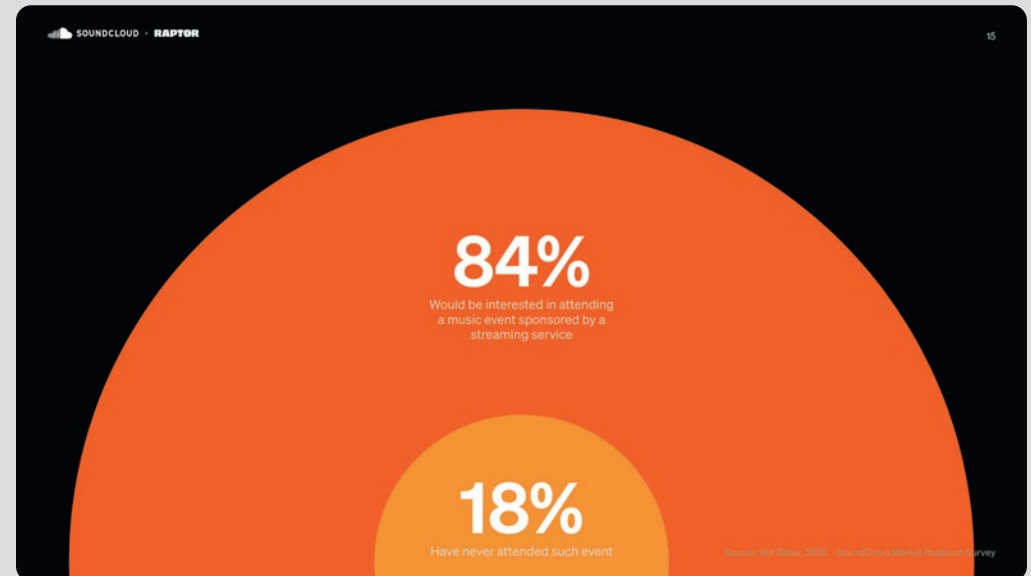
I aimed to fix this through in-person events dedicated to niche genres, with a deep level of interaction through the SoundCloud App.





So What?

To turn this sentiment into usage, SoundCloud must move from being a passive place to listen to music, to an active hub for culture and engagement, by bringing it into the real world.



I conducted market research into Gen Z, revealing that they respond well to SoundCloud's values, but still chose competitors products. I also explored what this means for the campaign, as well as potential routes to explore to improve engagement.



The App

The companion app is accessed **through a widget on the SoundCloud app**. When pressed, the user enters the event code, where they can then **react to the songs, and have their comments appear on the screen**.

As well as this, they can **add songs to the queue**, as well as **voting on existing ones**.

Once the event is over, the final **mix is automatically added to their SoundCloud library**, as well as the live reactions, acting as a keepsake of their time at the event.



Alongside the live events would be a companion widget built into the SoundCloud app. They can join others in reacting to the songs with emojis, text or photos, as well as vote on upcoming songs, ensuring the audience are listening to songs they actually want to listen to.

At the end of the night, the final mix is uploaded to SoundCloud, along with the reactions, as a keepsake of their time at the event.



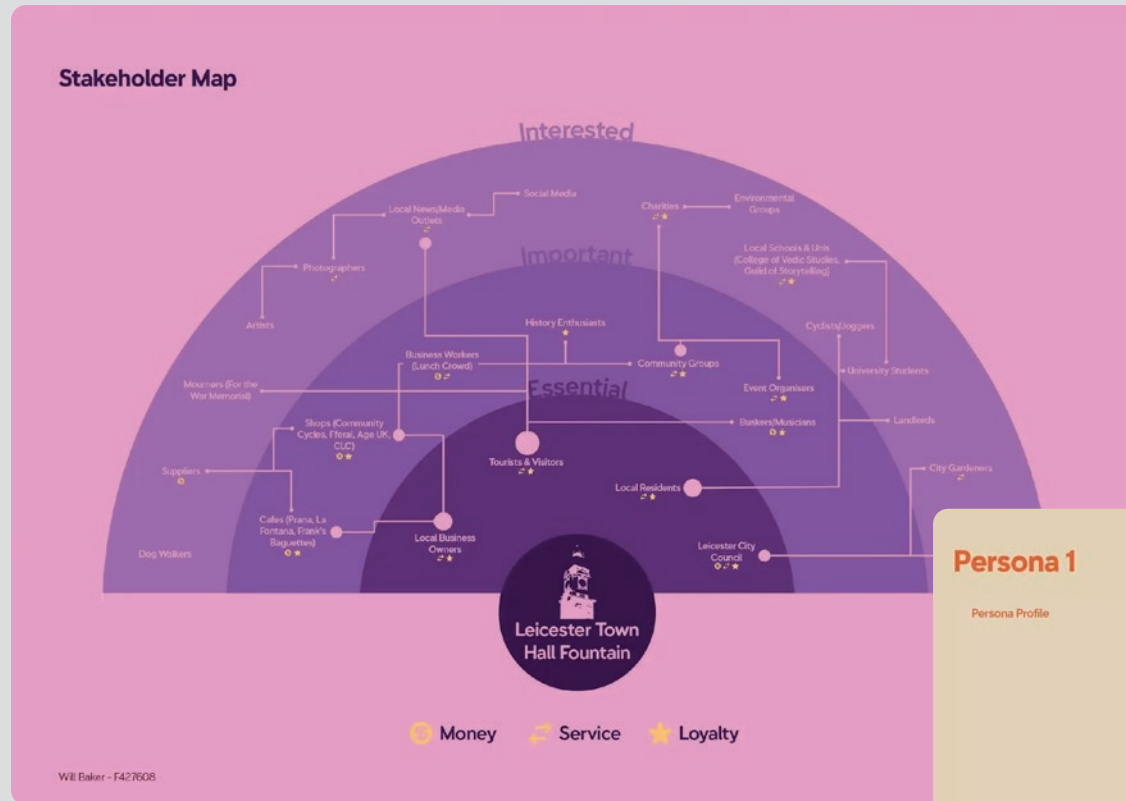
The Fountain

This project repositioned Leicester's Town Hall Fountain as a more inviting public space. Research and persona mapping led to two identity routes: one using the fountain's gargoyles, the other a clean monogram with pastel colours. Both explored logos, typography, colour and animation to present the fountain as a place to pause and connect.

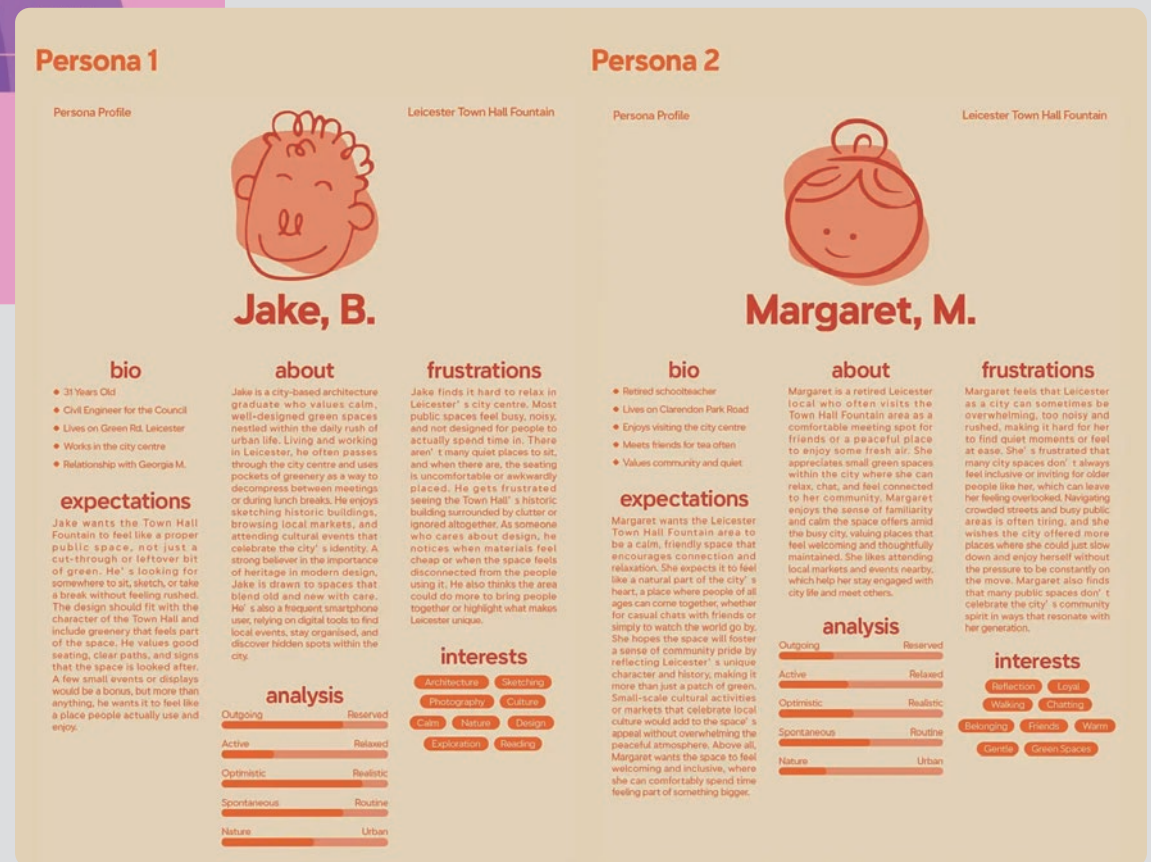


THE FOUNTAIN

F
the fountain

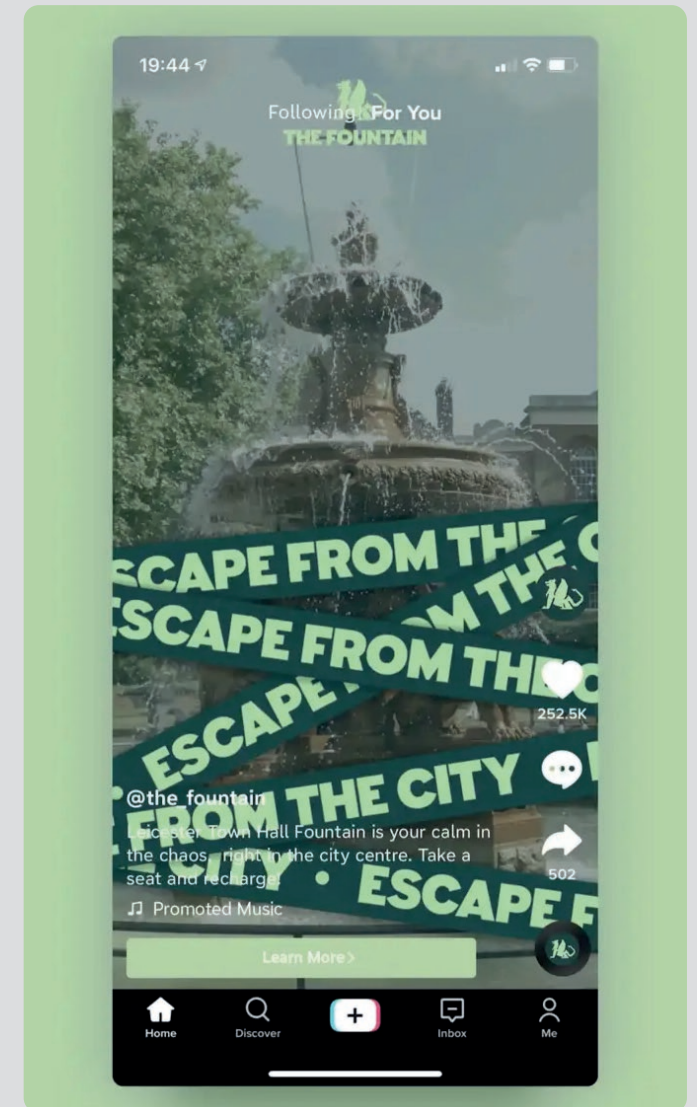


I mapped the main groups around the fountain, workers, residents, visitors and the council, each with different needs. To make this more tangible, I created personas showing everyday behaviours, like a worker seeking calm or a resident wanting a welcoming place to meet friends, which guided inclusive design choices.





The first concept simplifies the fountain's gargoyles into clean, small-scale logos suitable for print and digital. It uses bold contrasts to give the heritage imagery a modern edge, keeping the identity recognisable and flexible for various applications.



F
the fountain



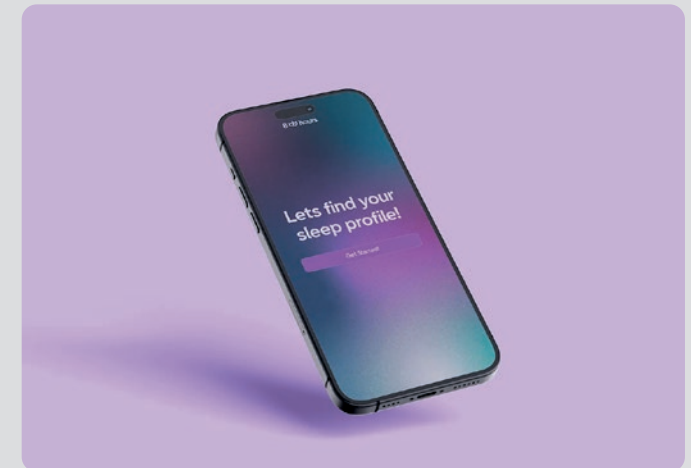
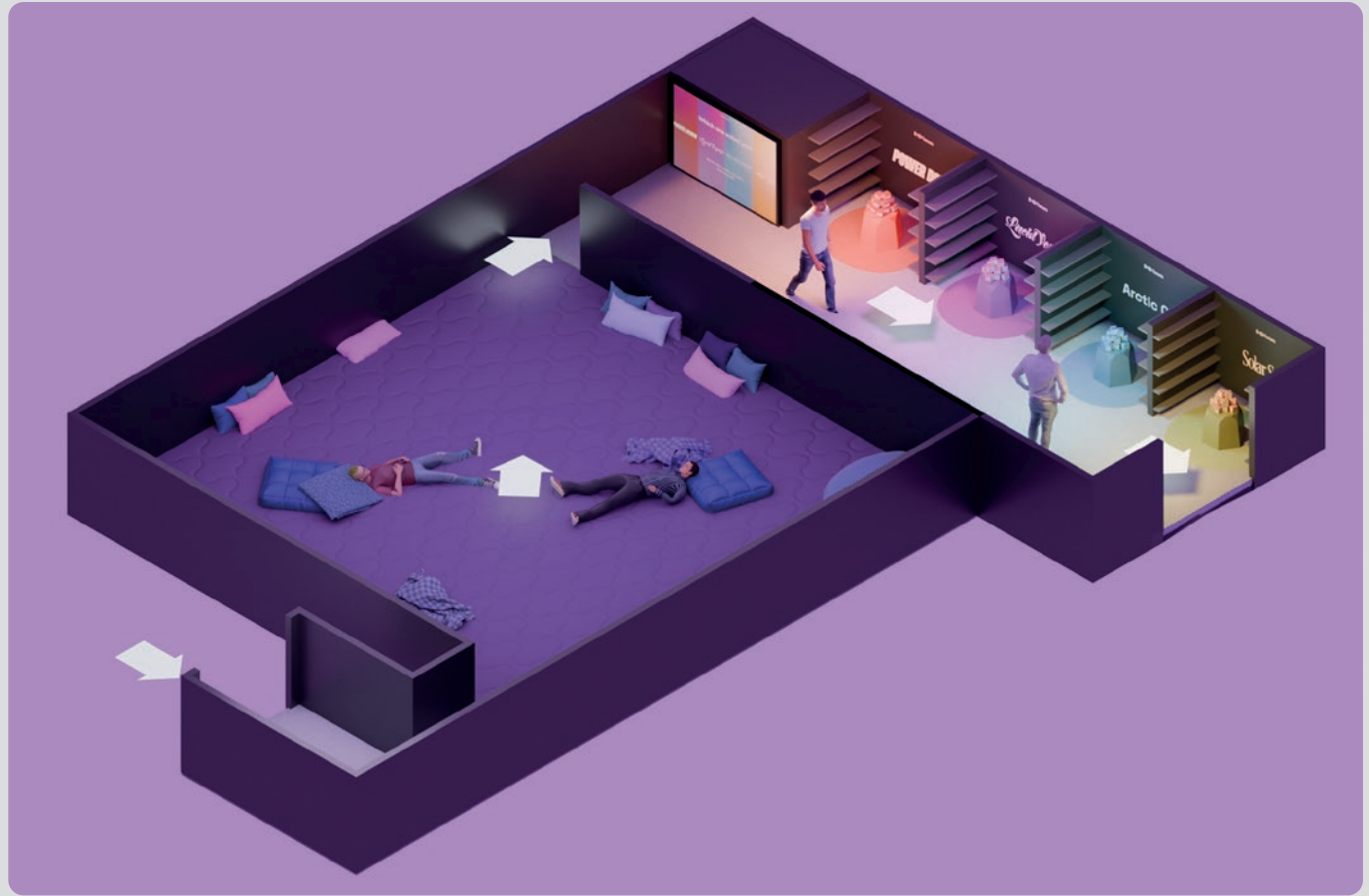
The second concept presents a modern monogram with a soft pastel palette for a lighter, approachable feel. The logo is clear at small sizes, with minimal typography and colour to create a calm, inclusive brand presence for the fountain as a welcoming public space.



8 Hours

8 Hours is a fictional sleep wellness brand I created as the foundation for an immersive university experience tackling the UK's sleep deprivation crisis. With over 75% of adults getting less than the recommended 8 hours, the project targets the 18–24 demographic.

The experience takes place during Freshers Week, where students lie on a soft mattress floor and watch an introductory animation on a ceiling-mounted LED screen. They then take a group quiz via a companion app, answering questions that range from playful to serious about their sleeping habits. At the end, they're matched to one of four personalised herbal patch variants, Power Down, Lucid Voyage, Arctic Chill, or Solar Sync.



Persona 1 8 Hours Experience

The Sport Player



Leo, 20

who Leo is a first-team rugby player. His life is a constant oscillation between peak physical exertion and social chaos. He's up at 5:30 AM for drills but stays at the Student Union until 1:00 AM on Wednesday nights. He's physically exhausted but often too "wired" from adrenaline or pre-workout supplements to actually drift off.

frustrations He finishes a high-stakes match at 9:00 PM, his body is exhausted, but his brain is buzzing from the game and the post-match celebrations. He lays in bed with a racing heart, unable to "drop off."

Because his wake-up times vary wildly (5:00 AM for training, 10:00 AM for recovery days), he never feels truly rested.

expectations He wants to learn about Active Recovery. He's looking for the "8 Hours" experience to teach him that sleep is a legal performance enhancer. He wants to leave knowing how to lower his core temperature or heart rate quickly after a late-night game to help enter the state of recovery quicker.

personality

Extroversion 

Routine-Driven 

Tech-Dependency 

Stress Level 

interests

Athletics Recovery Rugby
Socials Protein FIFA 25
Drinking Gym

He knows sleep impacts his stats, which creates a paradoxical stress: "I have to sleep to play well tomorrow," which makes it harder to sleep.

Persona 2 8 Hours Experience

The Working Student



Maya, 21

who Maya works 16 hours a week at a local coffee shop to cover her rent. Between shifts, studio time, and trying to maintain a semblance of a social life, sleep is her lowest priority. She treats sleep as a luxury she can't afford, often doing her laundry at midnight and answering emails at 2:00 AM.

frustrations Since her day is dictated by her boss and her tutors, nighttime is the only time she feels "in control." She scrolls on her phone for two hours simply because it's her only "me-time," even though she's exhausted.

After a shift at a coffee shop or retail store, the "ping" of a notification or the hum of a refrigerator feels magnified. She can't find "quiet" even in a dark room.

expectations She hopes to learn Sleep Efficiency. She wants the experience to prove that a structured "8 Hours" routine actually buys her more time the next day by increasing her focus. She'll be the most interested in the customised products a personalized kit that makes the wind-down feel like a luxury ritual rather than a chore.

personality

Extroversion 

Routine-Driven 

Tech-Dependency 

Stress Level 

interests

Design Budget Art
Coffee Thrifting TikTok
Fashion Friends

Persona 3 8 Hours Experience

The Academic Weapon



Ethan, 19

who Ethan is a perfectionist. He is a regular at the 24-hour library. He fuels his 14-hour study sessions with energy drinks and focus playlists. He considers an all-nighter a badge of honor, even though he knows his retention is dropping. His natural circadian rhythm is non-existent and rarely sees the sun.

He spends 12+ hours looking at screens. Even when he closes his eyes, he can see the glow of his laptop.

He uses caffeine to stay up and then considers using pills to get down. He hates the groggy feeling of sleep meds but doesn't know how else to stop his brain from revising Law cases at 3:00 AM.

frustrations

He feels productive while staying up, but realizes the next day that he can't remember half of what he read.

expectations He wants to learn the Science of Memory Consolidation. He needs the 8 Hours experience to explain why herbal remedies and blocking blue light will help him get a First-Class degree. He wants to leave with a Study/Sleep Schedule that treats rest as a cognitive tool.

personality

Extroversion 

Routine-Driven 

Tech-Dependency 

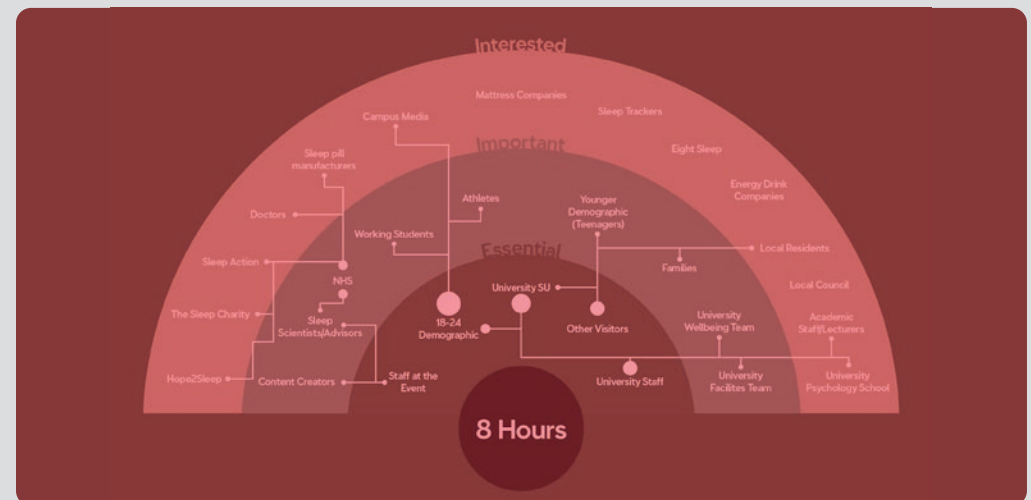
Stress Level 

interests

Library Gaming Data
Grades Exams Focus
Energy Drinks Law

The project started off by first gathering insight into my demographic. I conducted research into various different types of students (sporty/working/academic) and how they'd interact with my experience/products.

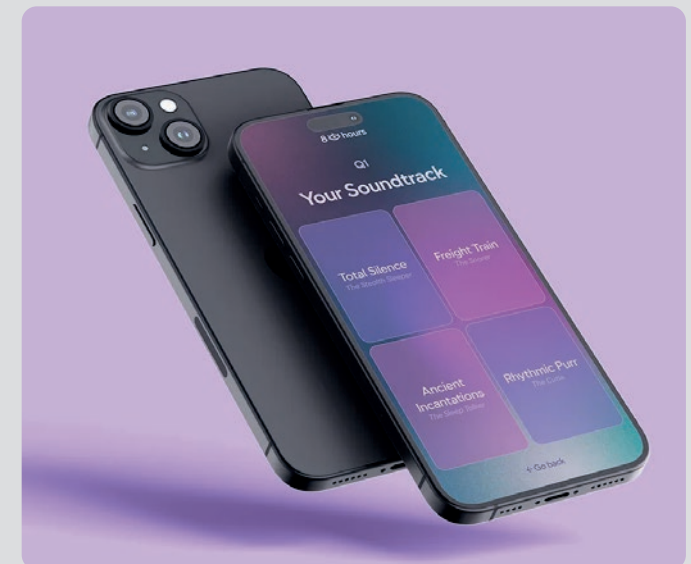
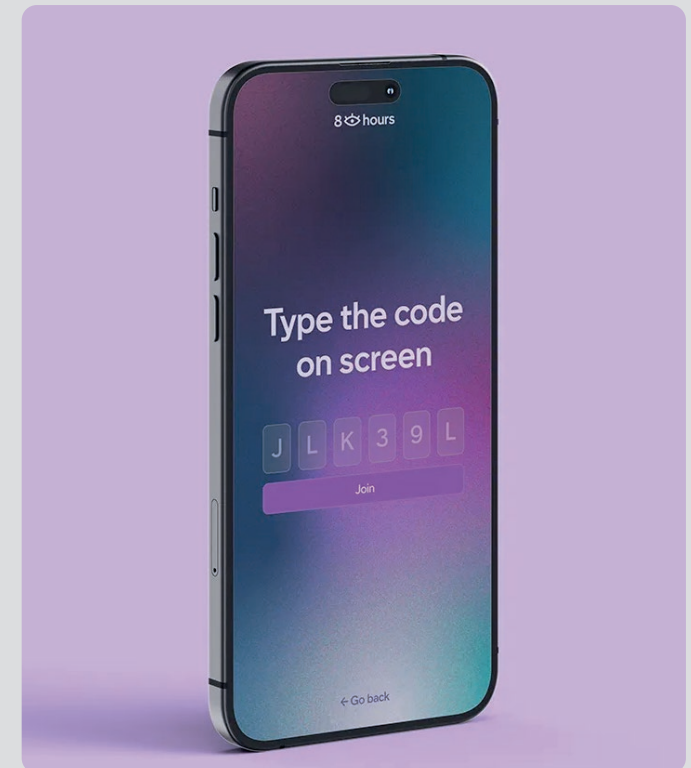
I also looked at different how different companies and stakeholders interact with the project (University staff, sleep professionals, NHS, etc).

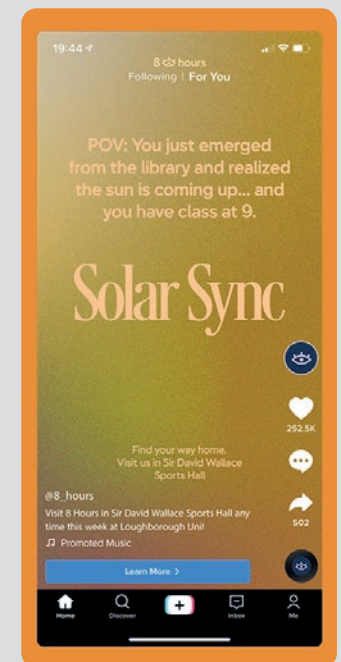
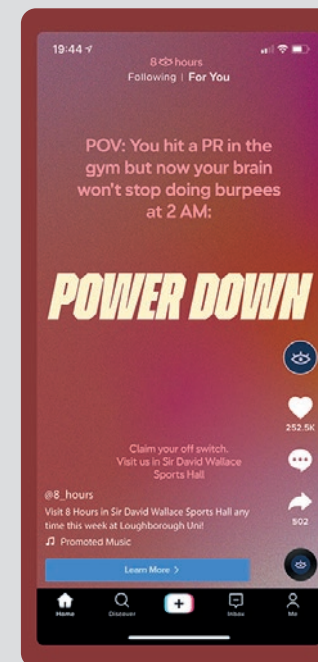
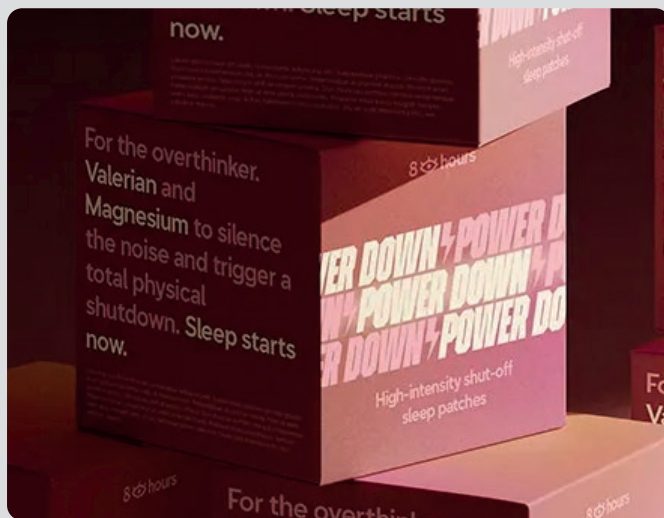
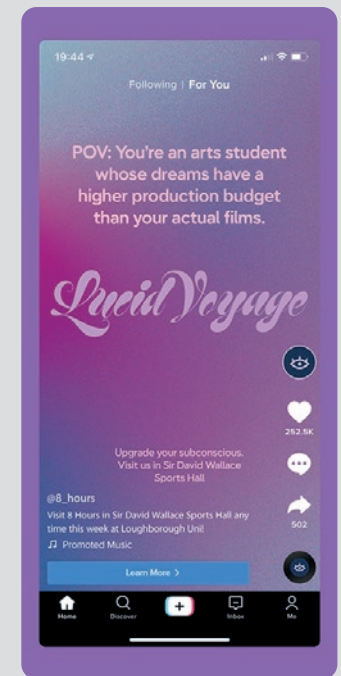
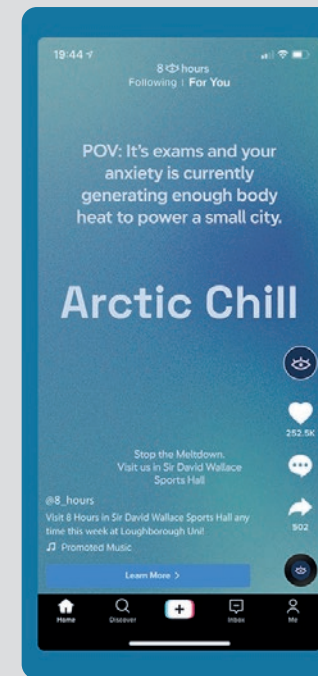


The logo for '8 hours' features a stylized eye icon where the pupil is a dot and the iris is a circle with three eyelashes. The number '8' is to the left and the word 'hours' is to the right, all in a white, sans-serif font. The background is a gradient of purple and blue with a fine, grainy texture.

I then created some branding for my fictional company. This included a logo, an animated logo, type, copywriting, as well as art direction involving the use of colours and gradients within the use of products/promotional material etc.

I also created an introductory video that would play in my experience. You can watch it both in situ and on its own here: <https://willb.cc/project/8-hours>

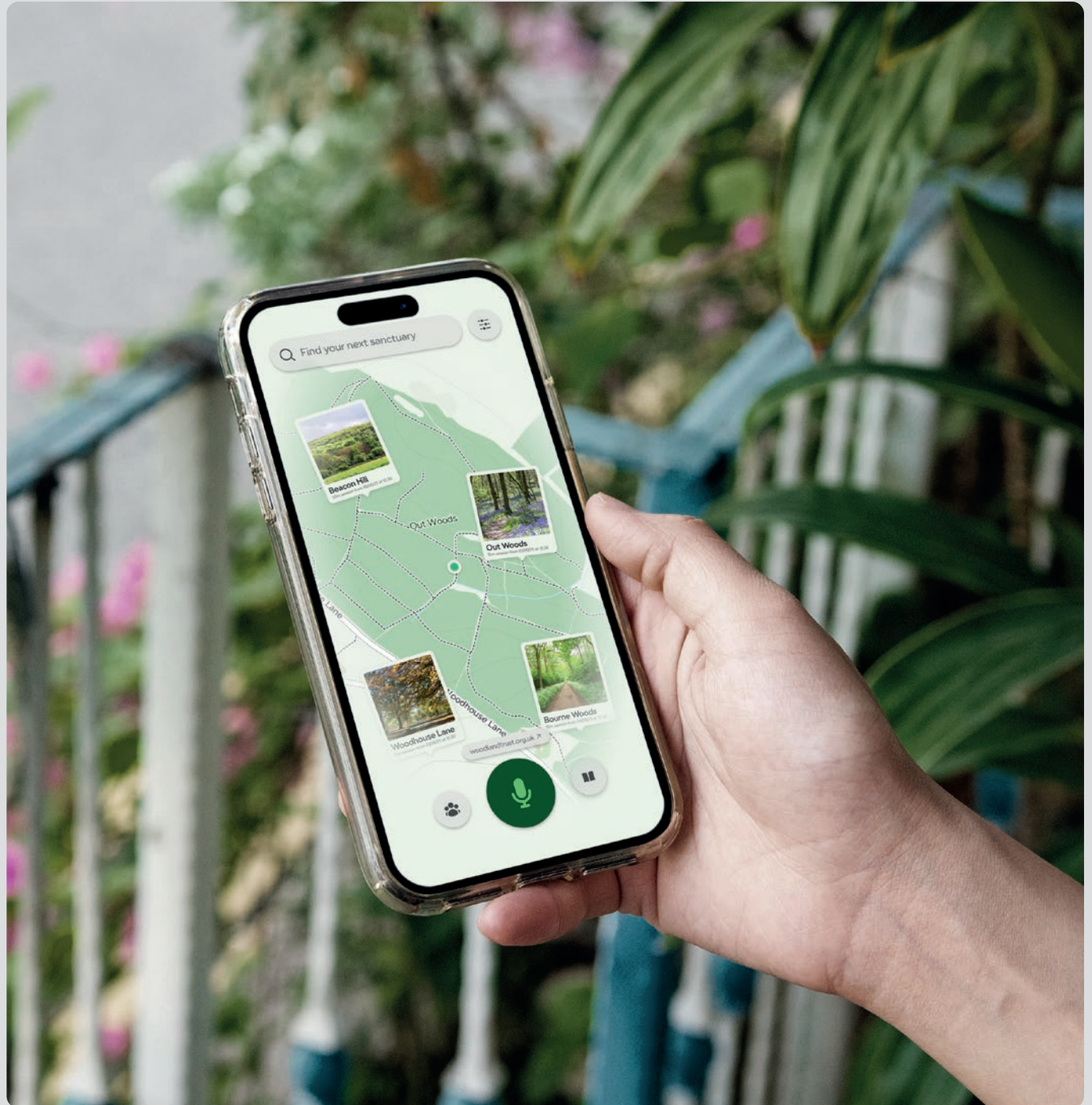
A dark blue to black gradient background. The word 'sleep' is repeated in a white, sans-serif font, arranged in a circular path around the center. In the center, the text 'OF PEOPLE DON'T GET ENOUGH' is written in a bold, white, sans-serif font.



Based on the visual identity, I also created the different products for the audience to take home, as well as a social media campaign to help generate traction and excitement.

Resonance

This project explores how design can make biodiversity loss feel more immediate and personal. It centres on a meditation-style app that uses woodland sounds and local species information to encourage mindfulness and reflection. By slowing down and noticing nature, users are introduced to biodiversity data in a way that feels calm and accessible. The app also connects people to volunteering opportunities, turning awareness into action and helping them see how their wellbeing links to the health of the environment.



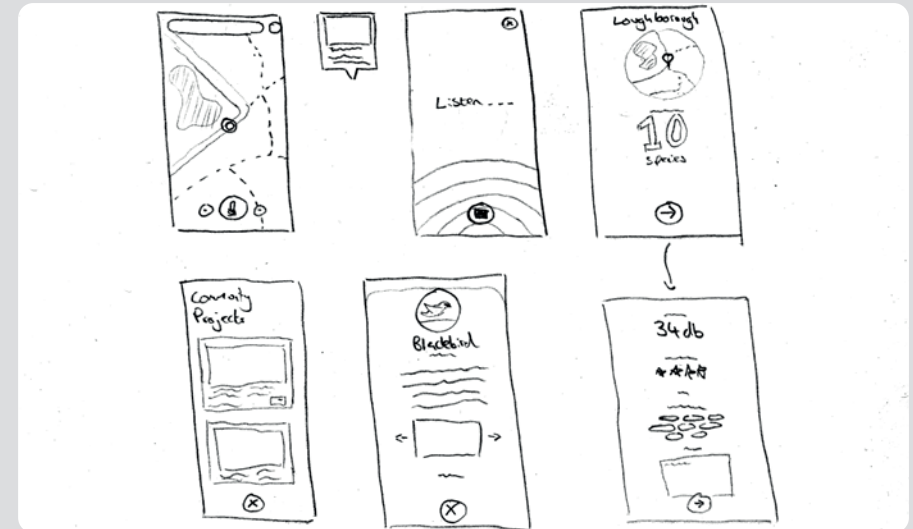
In collaboration with  The Woodland Trust

Resonance

This project was created to encourage environmental awareness by helping users slow down, listen, and reconnect with the natural world. With UK woodlands in decline and biodiversity falling sharply, the app turns complex statistics into something easier to understand and experience. It uses reflective interaction to inspire awareness and a sense of responsibility, showing how design can be both practical and purposeful. The main audience is women aged 18–30, a group more likely to face mental health challenges and benefit from mindfulness-based tools, though the app is open to anyone interested in nature and wellbeing.



Will Baker - F427608



Meditation Pages

The app guides users through calm breathing while listening to woodland sounds, with species gently appearing on-screen as they are identified.

After each session, personalised summaries turn statistics into engaging narratives that highlight biodiversity trends and encourage reflection. The user is also asked to share their thoughts of the location, which is then shared on the local map.

This project takes a product-focused UX/UI approach, designing an experience that feels calm, intuitive, and emotionally engaging. Design decisions prioritised clarity and ease of use, with a minimal interface, soft motion, and considered hierarchy to avoid overwhelming users.

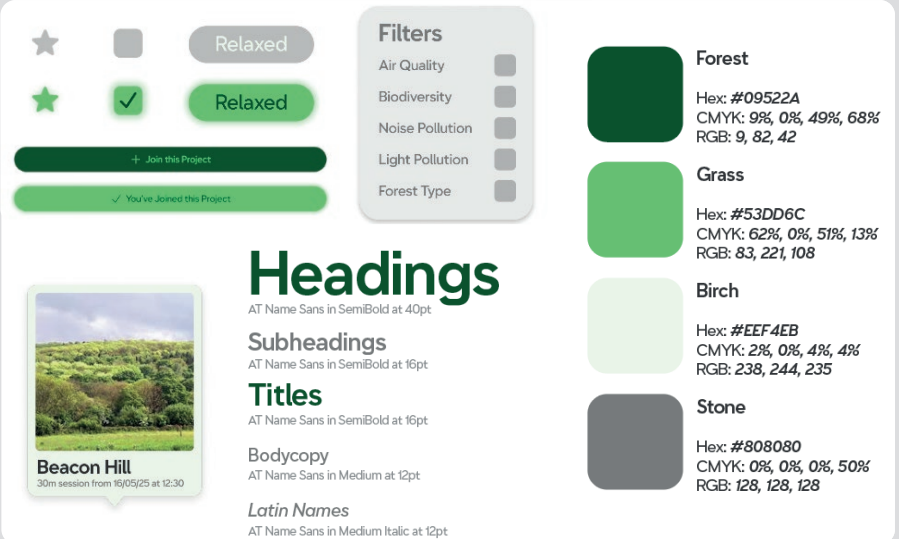


Will Baker - F427608

Social Design - AC2020

Information Pages

The app includes a species library where the user can find animals and plants they've encountered in the woodlands. These pages highlight the local biodiversity and encourage curiosity. To build on this awareness, the app also includes a volunteering section, connecting users directly to conservation projects and community initiatives.



Features were intentionally revealed through interaction, encouraging exploration rather than instruction, and helping users build understanding at their own pace.

Local and personalised content was used to make the experience feel relevant and meaningful, while the overall flow guides users from quiet reflection toward deeper engagement and involvement.



Link to Figma App

<https://www.figma.com/proto/zoy1G8tRW7efl8TelegEpa/Social-Design>



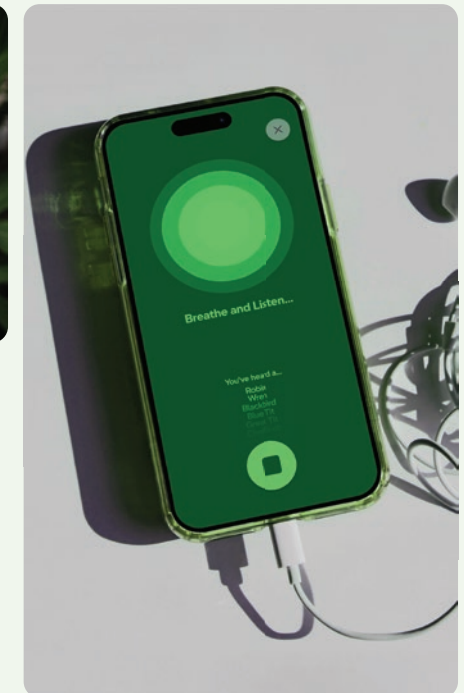
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Will Baker - F427608



Social Design - ACB140

Ardua

This project focused on modular typography, leading to the design of Ardua, a tall geometric display font created for Birmingham Design Festival. It draws on Bauhaus and Braun influences, with a variable crossbar and cutout details that make it flexible for motion and display use. The work included type experiments and specimen design, showing a clear balance of research and practical application.

5



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QRSTU

VWXYZ

ardua

The typeface Ardua was developed by Will Baker in response to a brief posed by the 2025 Birmingham Design Festival. The brief was to create a modular display typeface to help promote the festival and its theme of "Play".

Inspiration was drawn from the festival's goal to celebrate the "local national and international design industry" (BDF, n) and the typeface certainly reflects this ambition with its imposing physical stature.

The font carries a cap height in an almost monospaced package, creating a font reminiscent of the Bauhaus movement, but more similar to its predecessor, the style Braun's design, created by Dieter Rams. This comparison is made even more obvious by comparing the typeface to Braun's logo by Wolfgang Schmitt (1952), both using a similar grid-based design with uniform curves. This geometric precision enhances the typeface's legibility, making it particularly suited for display purposes.

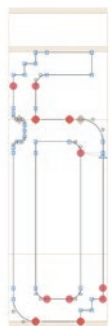
Ardua leans into the theme of play by introducing a unique variable crossbar. This allows the designer to play, edit and adjust the typeface to fit into any

of speakers from various backgrounds. Furthermore, this dynamic aspect makes it uniquely suited for motion graphics, instigating a spark of life into what otherwise could be an uninspiring design. Additionally, the

AR DUA

read in large sizes and to be used as for an impactful title or heading. The heavy weight of the lettering, along with the tall cap height and decorative elements, effects its legibility when used in body copy and as such, not recommended for it.

Within the V0X Classification system (1954), Ardua falls under a lineal geometric typeface as it is a sans serif font with a



Ardua 48pt CSBR 0

ABCDEFGHIJK
LMNOPQRSTU
VWXYZ

Ardua 48pt CSBR 50

ABCDEFGHIJK
LMNOPQRSTU
VWXYZ

Ardua 48pt CSBR 100

ABCDEFGHIJK
LMNOPQRSTU
VWXYZ

Fruitful

This project explores the concept of flavourings through the creation of a fictional fruit tea brand, Fruitful Tea Co. The brand was designed to feel both playful and professional, with a focus on bold, eye-catching visuals and a modern identity.

The project includes packaging design, promotional materials, and a website for the subscription-based delivery service. Branding was kept consistent through the development of clear guidelines, applied across posters, web design, and product mockups. The aim was to create a recognisable and engaging presence that could stand out in a crowded market.



Ampliear

I worked on a campaign to show how Ampliear hearing aids make sound clearer. Using research and design experiments, I created posters and mockups with retro-tech visuals and simple distortion effects to highlight the shift from muffled to clear sound. The final pieces included billboard concepts with the line "Hear the Difference, Feel the Change."



LSU Media

During my time within LSU Media, I undertook a variety of roles which often required me to make graphics for a wide range of mediums. I've worked with the editors of the LABEL Magazine to create a handful of spreads on different topics, creating engaging and visually coherent designs.

As well as this, as the Technical Officer, I also created some posters to help teach new members the various different types of cables. My latest project with media involved creating the opening sequence for the National Student Television Awards, a synced visual with immersive laser effects, visuals and sound design. The the sequence was celebrated multiple times by the hosts, and various judges, including Chris Cook, the Creative Director of BBC News. You can see the final video on my website: <https://willb.cc/project/nasta-intro>



Cable Cheatsheet

	HDMI Digital cable carrying video and audio in one connector. Common on cameras, projectors, presentation laptops and capture devices. coated in placeholder		SDI Professional digital video designed for long, reliable cable runs. Used in broadcast cameras and vision mixers. Features a locking connector. coated in placeholder
	Component 3-line video format with separate red, green, and blue connectors. Still found on older camera equipment. coated in placeholder		IEC Standard power cable used on PCs, monitors, recorders, and studio equipment. Very common across a wide range of device/power supplies. coated in placeholder
	13A Standard UK mains plug. Powers most of our equipment. Often seen with a different connector on the end, or as an extender (or gang). coated in placeholder		16A Higher-rated industrial/event power connector, often used in venues or outside spaces. coated in placeholder
	Powercon A locking mateable connector for event power used for stage lighting, PA racks, and within a lot of rack-mounted equipment. Can sometimes be taken "out" of equipment to power multiple devices. coated in placeholder		Figure 8 Two-pin power lead for lower power devices. Common on small media players and some power supplies. coated in placeholder
	12V DC Barrel Jack Low-voltage power for cameras, and small devices. Often used on portable rigs or battery-powered setups. coated in placeholder		Micro USB Small connector for powering or updating portable devices. Used primarily on the micromouse. coated in placeholder



LSU Graphics

Produced digital and print design across campaigns, events, and student initiatives, including event branding, posters, signage, and social media stories. Designed fast-turnaround content for channels reaching 25k+ followers, balancing clear messaging with bold visuals to engage a diverse student audience. Collaborated closely with the Students' Union team to adapt designs across multiple touchpoints and ensure consistency both online and on campus.

I also developed lighting and club visuals for the SU club, creating complex node graphs to allow the visuals to be automated when less experienced techs were working. More information about this, along with videos can be found on my website: <https://willb.cc/project/su-club>

